

Case Study

Agentic AI for Shopping & the Commercial Browser

About me



Mixed methods researcher who thrives on variety

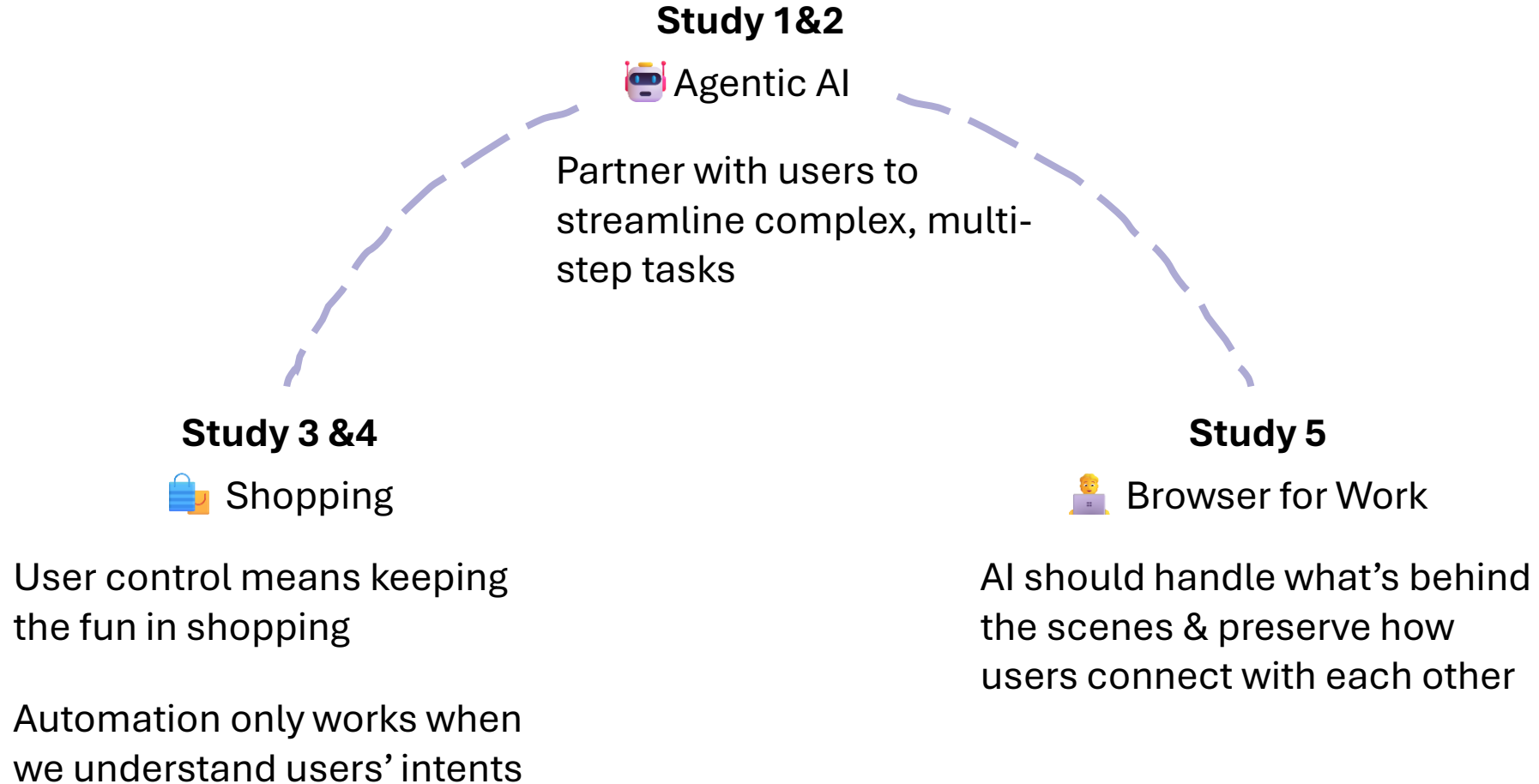
PhD in Social Psychology

Defining & explaining 'uncanny' feelings
Attitudes towards democracy

Microsoft (MAI)

Led 35 studies across Edge (Consumer, Enterprise), Shopping, Copilot, GroupMe, Character, Read aloud, Bing, more

How to create agentic AI experiences that support human decision-making instead of replacing it



Context

February 2025, after ChatGPT Operator launches

Microsoft is exploring Agentic AI that...

~~Takes control? Automates?~~

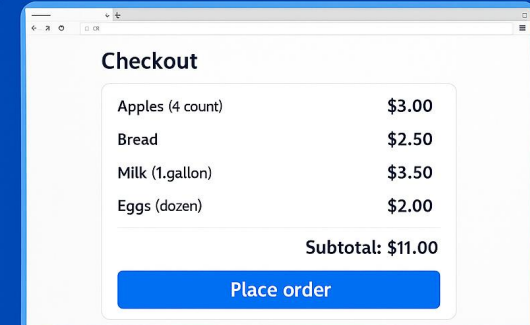
~~Completes tasks on your behalf?~~

Browses for you?

Grocery Checkout

In progress

Open window



Checkout

Apples (4 count)	\$3.00
Bread	\$2.50
Milk (1.gallon)	\$3.50
Eggs (dozen)	\$2.00
Subtotal: \$11.00	

Place order



Take control

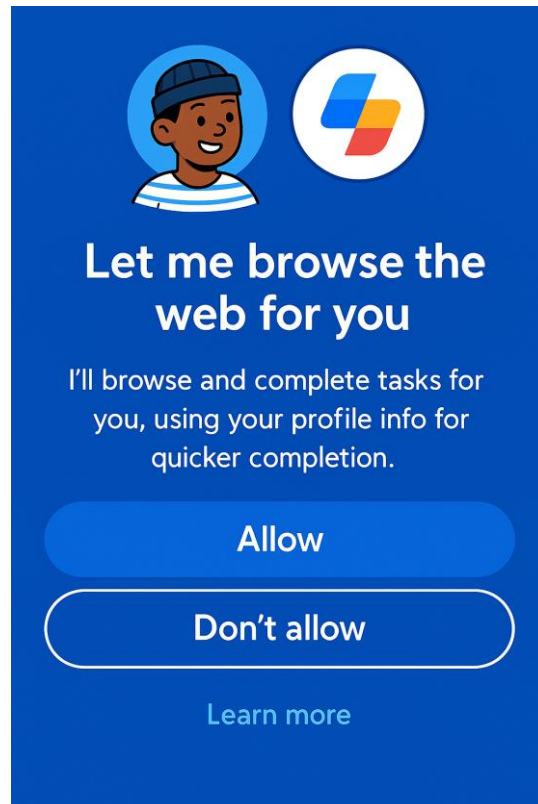
- ✓ Entering details
- ✓ Applying coupon
- Completing order

Which card would you like to use for payment?

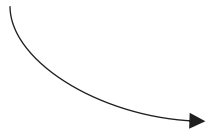
To finish checking out, I need your delivery address. Could you provide that for me?

I explored how to introduce users to a web-browsing agent

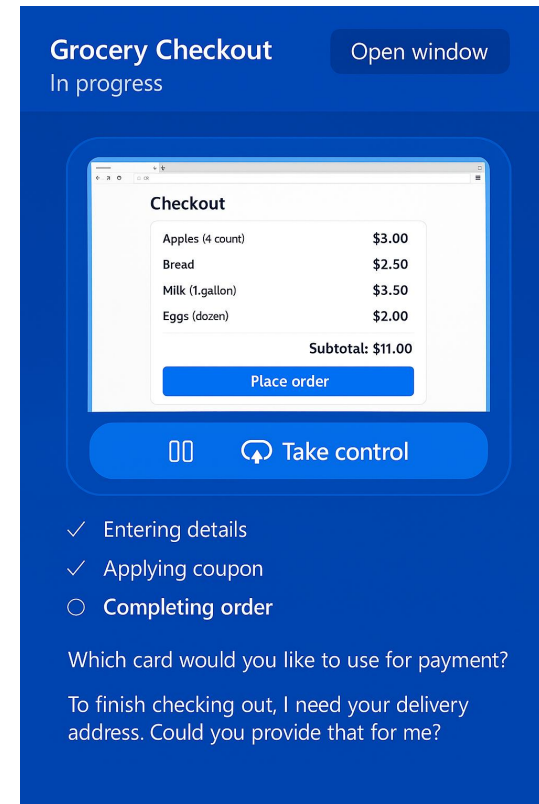
Study 1: Consent



Squad work was changed slightly for this presentation



Study 2: First Run Experience



Study 1: Consents

**Do users know
what they are
consenting to?**

Study 2: First Run Experience

**How do users
understand / feel
about using agentic
AI to complete
tasks online?**

Deliverables: memo and full presentation deck to design & product partners

Participants

Using Dscout, I recruited Copilot Pro and ‘Minimum Target’ users (medium-low fluency, medium-light Copilot user)

Study 1: Consent

Study 2: First Run Experience

Copilot Pro
Users



Michelle



Manal



Carlos



Jonathan



Mike



Scott



Ryan



John



Brian



Dylan

‘Minimum
Target’
Copilot Users

low AI fluency,
low AI trust



Regina



Kaleigh



Inez



Zachary



Robert



Joseph



Amy



Melissa



Evan



Daniel

Users would click 'Allow' without knowing what it means



Weak mental model of 'browse for you'

Users don't know what happens after clicking 'Allow'



Unsure what's included in their profile

They assumed email, location, and browsing history would be included, but *not* financial information



Let me browse the web for you

I'll browse and complete tasks for you, using your profile info for quicker completion.

Allow

Don't allow

[Learn more](#)

Insight

Agentic AI is unfamiliar, so users need clarity: what actions the product takes and exactly what personal data is used

We're adding complexity to the task instead of making users' lives easier



Why these bells and whistles?

The small window and extra buttons felt like overkill



Other solutions are more convenient

Auto-populating in the browser

Grocery Checkout

In progress

Open window

Checkout

Apples (4 count)	\$3.00
Bread	\$2.50
Milk (1.gallon)	\$3.50
Eggs (dozen)	\$2.00
Subtotal: \$11.00	

Place order



Take control

- ✓ Entering details
- ✓ Applying coupon
- Completing order

Which card would you like to use for payment?

To finish checking out, I need your delivery address. Could you provide that for me?

Insight

**AI delivers the
most value when
the task is
complex**

*“It’s more of a partner than
an assistant to me. I
wouldn’t use it this way.”*

–Brian, Copilot Pro User

*“It’s new, but it’s not
revolutionary. When it has
original thoughts... that’s
revolutionary.”* –Dylan, Copilot Pro User

The opportunity isn't just at checkout — it's in guiding users through the complexity that comes before and after



Impact

Recommendations:

Extended consent with tooltips

Agentic AI that partners with users to help them navigate complex decisions

Outcomes:

Short term– designers made rapid iterative changes

Long term– workstreams initiated foundational research

Context

April 2025, the Shopping workstream plans early for the holidays

What are the greatest opportunities for agentic AI and shopping?



Study 3

**Which moments in the shopping journey
create the strongest opportunities for
agentic AI?**

Deliverable: full presentation deck

From 143 documented shopping activities, I identified higher-level Jobs to Be Done:



Jobs to Be Done

Find

Find products that meet my needs and wants

Compare

Compare similar products on price, quality, shipping costs, etc.

Inspiration

Find shopping inspiration

Write

Write a product review

Negotiate

Negotiate a price with sellers

Purchase

Apply discounts and complete the purchase

Timing

Monitor my finances and price fluctuations to decide when to buy

Communicate

Communicate with sellers and Customer Support

Reviews

Interpret customer and/or expert reviews

Track

Keep track of when and how my order will arrive

Budget

Interpret finances and product options to decide on a budget

Wishlist

Save different product options for later

Exchange

Make an exchange or return

Deals

Find deals on products that meet my needs

Location

Find the best location to make an in-store purchase

Restock

Keep tabs on household stuff to buy and restock

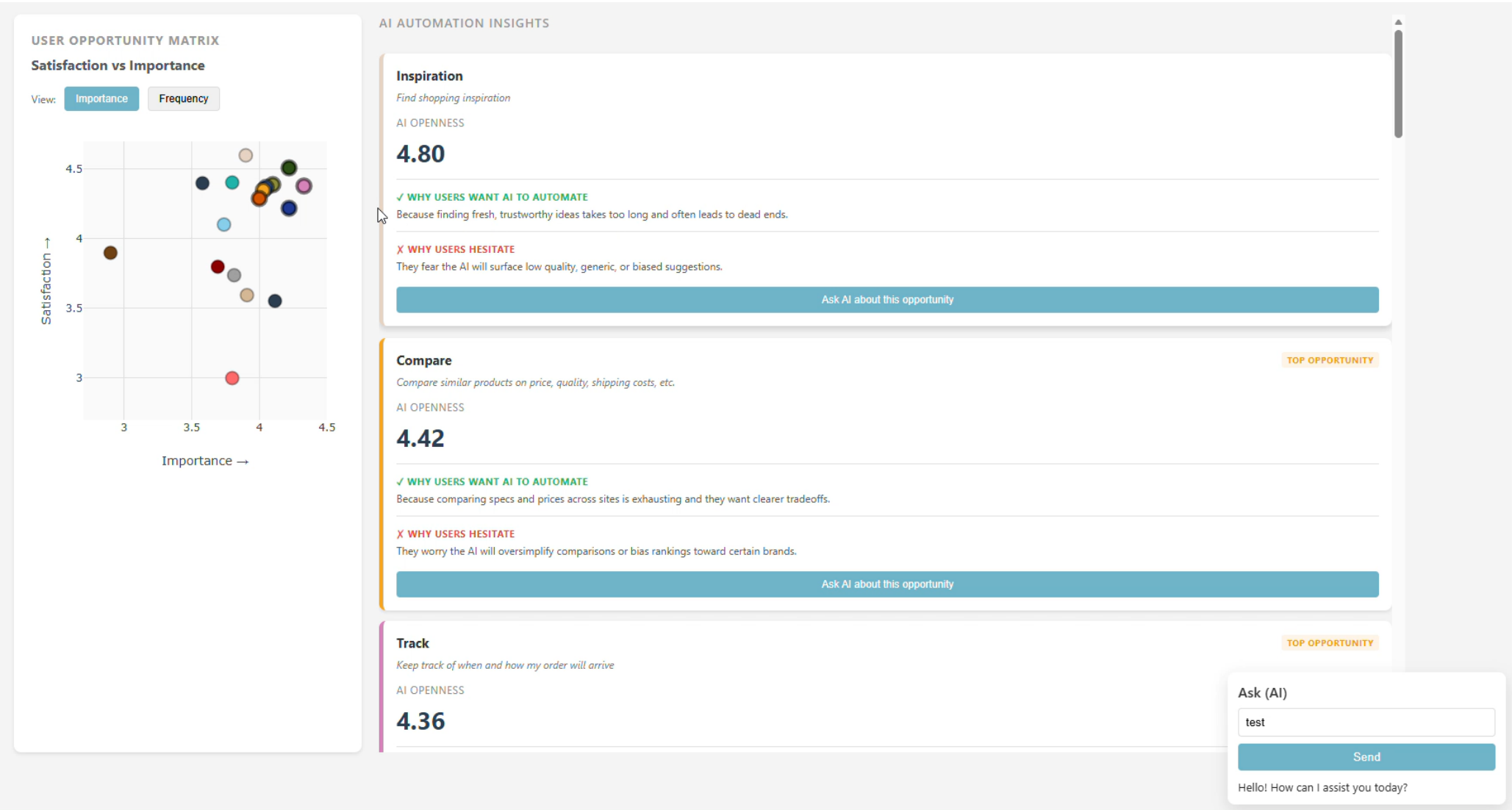
Subscribe

Manage a subscription

Opportunities identified among 1533 US participants

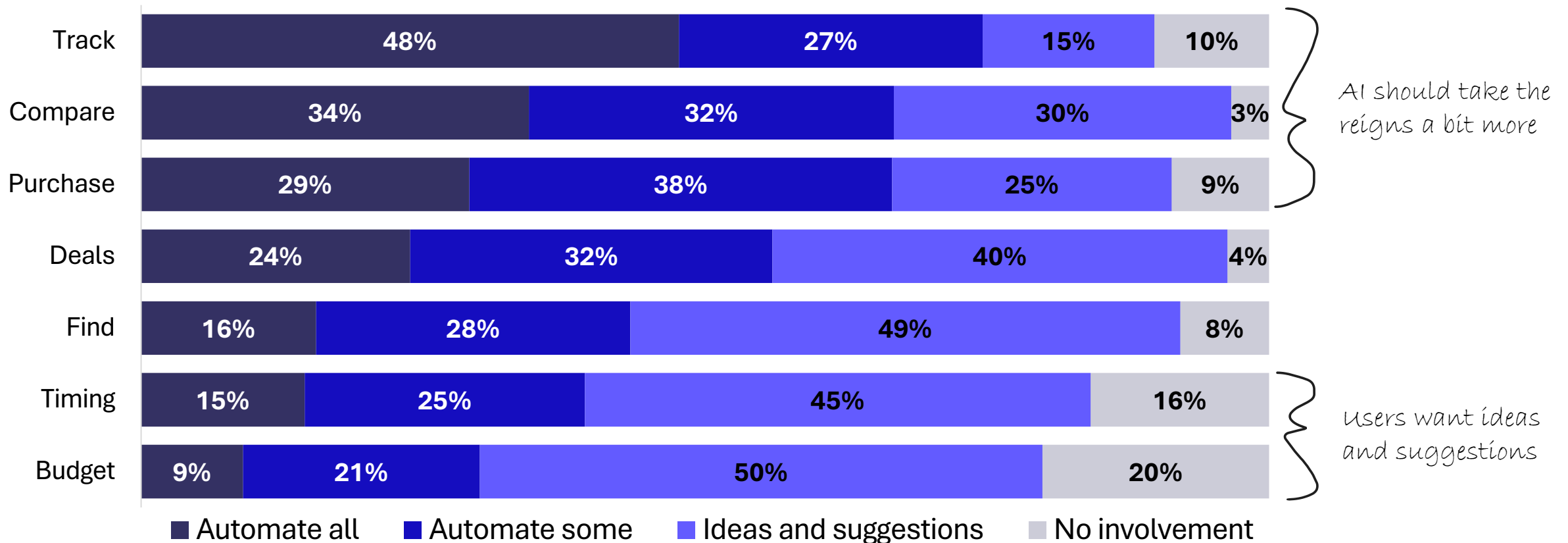
	Important	Satisfied	Frequency	AI Open
Find	4.51	4.22	4.01	4.11
Purchase	4.39	4.10	3.74	4.00
Track	4.38	4.33	3.70	▲ 4.25
Deals	4.37	4.05	3.85	▲ 4.36
Compare	4.35	4.03	▲ 3.94	▲ 4.42
Timing	4.29	4.00	3.41	▼ 3.31
Budget	4.22	4.09	3.28	▼ 3.20

Vibe-coded interactive output



Activities require more vs. less automation

Participants chose one of: AI should complete all of this activity for me, AI should complete part of this activity for me, AI should only offer ideas and suggestions, AI shouldn't help me with this activity at all



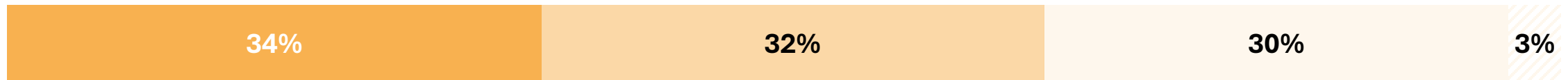
Compare | Users want AI to do it

How AI can help them compare similar products on price, quality, shipping costs, etc.

“This is a tedious process when you are comparing more than two things, and so AI completing this task saves valuable time for the consumer, which is huge in my opinion.”

“AI should be able to compare images, prices and reviews etc. and suggest the best options for me to review and make a final decision.”

How
should AI
be
involved?



■ Automate all ■ Automate some ■ Ideas and suggestions ■ No involvement

Who:  + Women  + Mil. / Gen Z

Where: 59%  /  35%

Deals | Users want AI to find deals but not act on them

How AI can help users find deals on products that meet needs and wants:

"I would like for AI to pull the product that I choose from every available vendor..."

"Doing anything other than notifying me is not wanted."

How
should AI
be
involved?



Who:  + Women  + Millennials

Where: 57%  /  37%

Insight

Keep the fun in shopping

“I enjoy browsing and discovering new things, especially when I’m shopping for something fun.”

-User, 23, Texas

“Searching for the best deal is almost like being on a treasure hunt.”

-User, 40, Illinois

Impact

Recommendations:

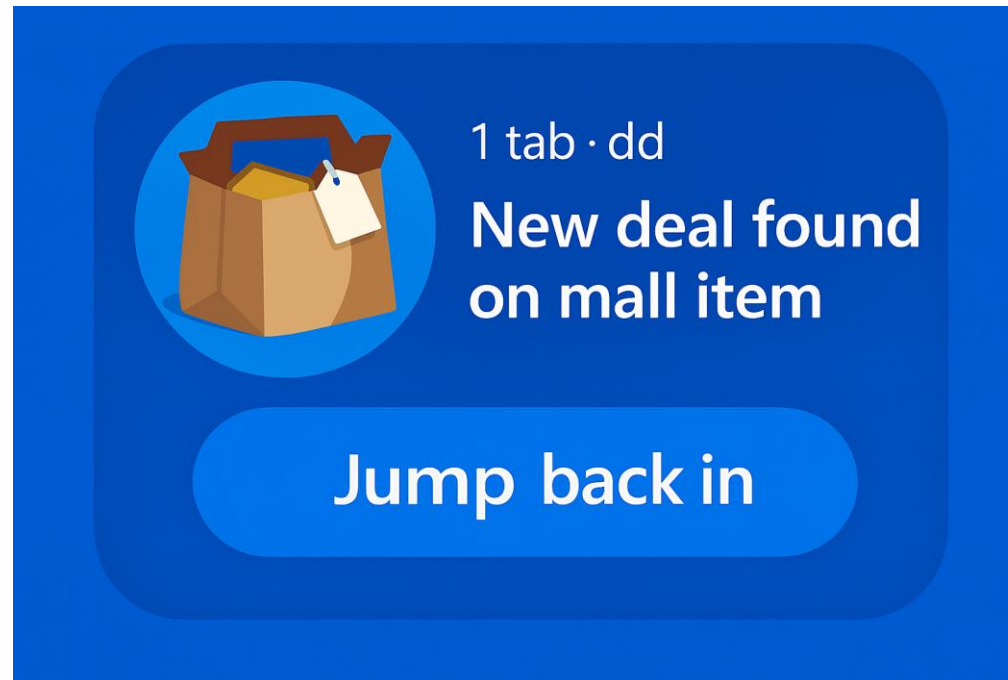
Seize AI opportunities like finding the right product, finding deals, comparing options, timing a purchase (with user control).

Outcome:

Designers developed concepts to explore these opportunities.

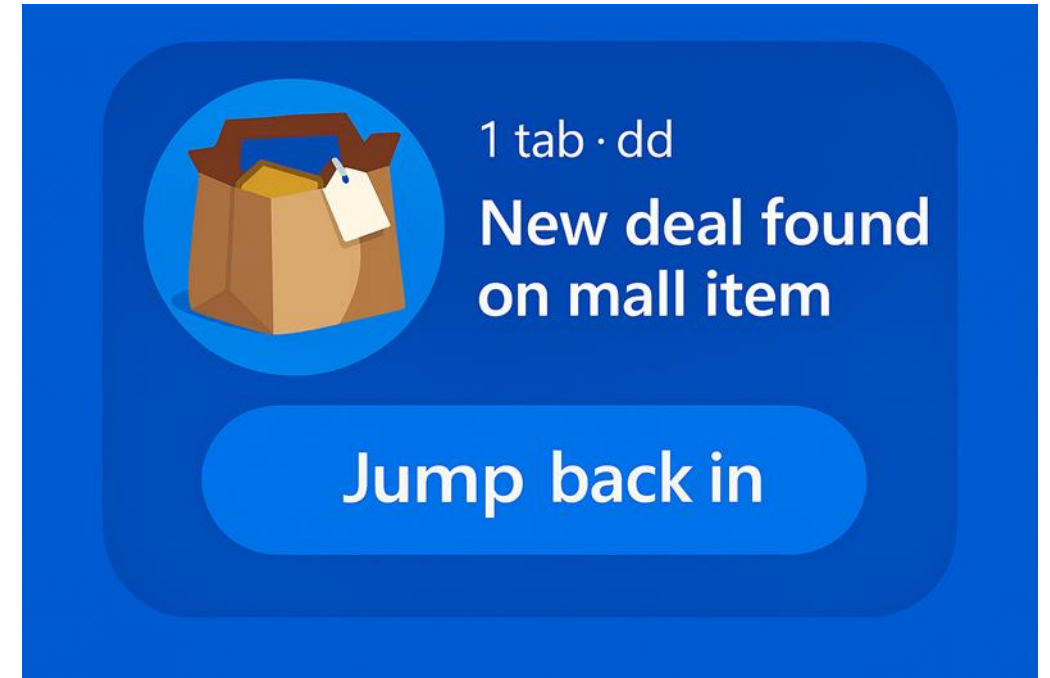
I helped the team prioritize & test 2 among 13 concepts

Concept: Continue Journey



Uses an existing pattern (Journey Cards on the New Tab Page) to help users get back into Shopping

Assumption: users move from in-store to online to find a better deal



Study 4

What helps users continue where they left off after in-person shopping?

Deliverable: full presentation deck

Participants

I recruited Edge users from UserTesting who move between online and in-person shopping:



Liam



Matt



Andrea



Hanson



Stephanie



Onika



Heather



Genevieve

Deal hunting is only one among many reasons why users continue searching online



Finding a better price



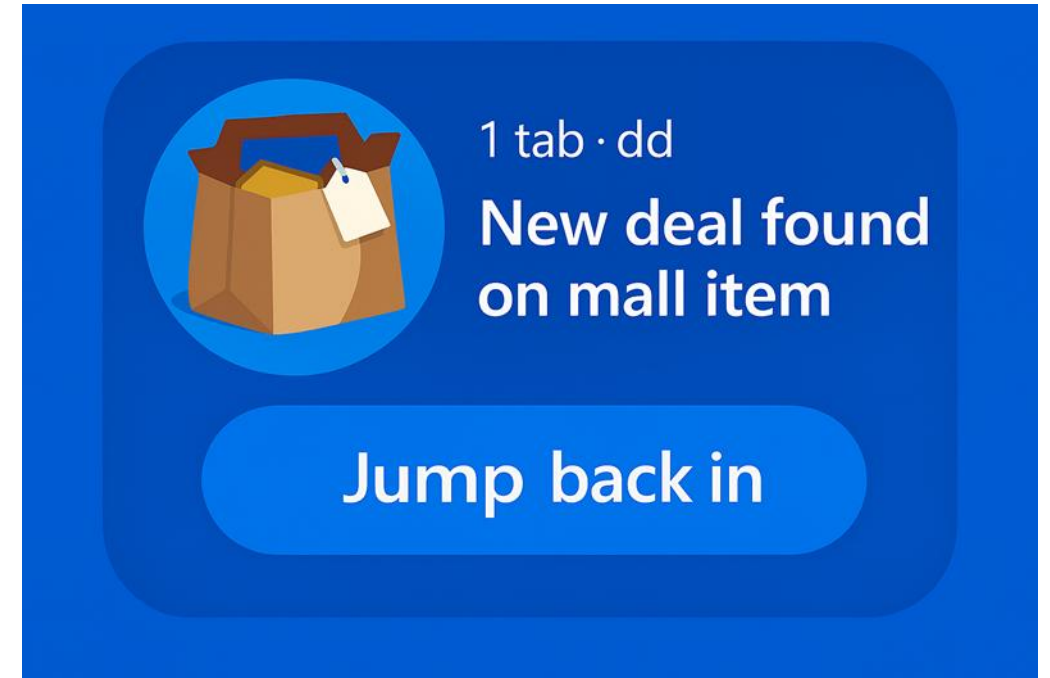
Variety seeking



Conducting more research



Controlling impulses



Insight

**We need to know
when and why users
are switching to
online so we can
tailor the experience**

*“If it was Nike or Adidas, I
might want the best price. But
if it’s just a normal shoes, I
might be looking for variety.”*

–Matt, Edge user

*“I think it would also be
nice to see the customer
reviews right alongside
the deal.”*

–Andrea, Edge user

Impact

Recommendations:

The same action can signal different Jobs to Be Done: deal-hunting, finding the right item, or seeking inspiration. Build for different intents.

Outcome:

High-level concept enters the next stage in the product development cycle

Context

October 2025, less than a month
before the Ignite conference

**Browser for Work is an
AI-first browser. Who are
our users, and what are
they trying to do?**



Study 5

What do our commercial browser users need & want, and where are the greatest opportunities for agentic AI?

Deliverables: full presentation deck & sprint planning

Participants

Chrome and Edge users, individual contributors, and people managers, in various roles, who use the browser at work, in 75 minute figjam sessions:

Research / product roles



Julia, Tech, Product
Operations Manager



Natasha, Consulting,
Risk Advisory



Rinkle, Insurance,
Operations Manager



Catherine,
Accounting, Tax
Accountant



Tejal, Consulting,
Business Analyst

Direct with customers / clients



Brianna, Healthcare,
Nurse



Gearoid, Education,
Teacher



Aurora, Social
Services, Crisis
Worker



Dylan, Automotive,
Manager



Rodney,
Transportation &
Logistics, Store
Manager

IT roles



Marc-Louis, Event
Services, Product
Analyst



Aurelio, Government, IT
Supervisor



Adnan, Government, IT
Risk Management



Christina,
Technology, Program
analyst

HR roles



Natalie, Healthcare,
HR Assistant



Elise, Financial Services,
Return to Work Specialist

Core Commercial Browser JTBD

Using secondary research and 1:1 user interviews as inputs:



Plan / coordinate

scheduling work & managing deadlines to monitor progress



Collaborate

editing, commenting, sharing feedback & ideas to produce a better outcome



Get answers

finding the right resources, documentation, or people to get the answer efficiently



Interpret

summarizing / synthesizing data, trends, & documentation into actionable insights



Inform

documenting progress & alerting stakeholders to communicate effectively



Research

exploring or researching a topic in-depth to gain new understanding

Create

produce valuable decks, memos, images, designs, graphs, charts, process maps, narratives, instructions, & translations

Influence

persuade, navigating conflicting interests, educate, foster engagement, drive decision-making

Learn

increasing knowledge or developing a new skill

Stay up to date

access news / updates from inside and outside the organization to be in the know

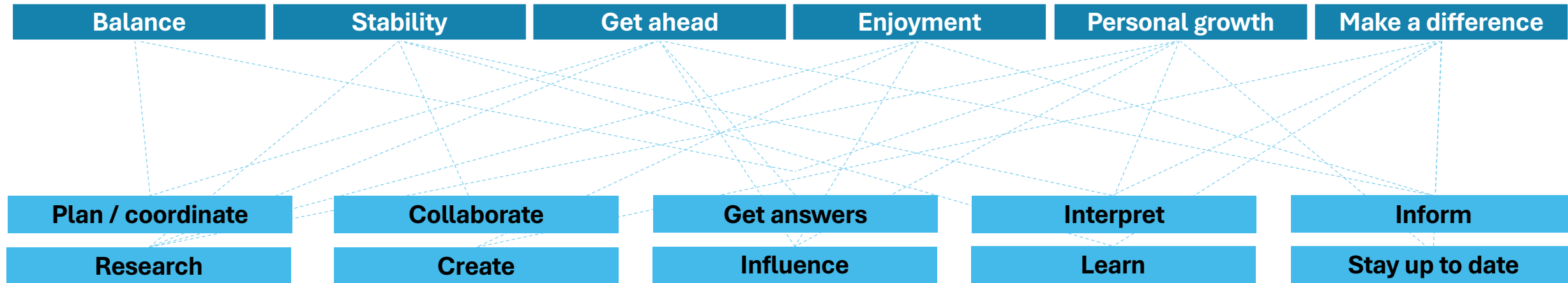
The Jobs to Be Done Framework reveals the job behind the activity, and the motivation behind the job

	Hire	Activity	Job	Motivation
Example:	Browser	By reading news	Stay informed about changes in the market	To make a difference

The JTBD framework yields: underlying needs, gaps, opportunities, other ‘hires’ (tools to accomplish the job)

[Read more](#)

Users' motivations to be at their jobs are variable



Examples: Our users **inform** for **stability**, to **get ahead**, or to **make a difference**

Our users **research** for **personal growth**, **mental stimulation**, or **stability**

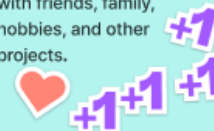
Our users **influence** to **make a difference**, **get ahead**, or for **personal growth**

Stakeholder exercise | users' motivations to be at their jobs are variable

Core Commercial Browser JTBD

 Plan / coordinate: schedule work & manage deadlines to monitor progress Rachele Benjamin (DIGITAL INTEL...)	 Influence: persuade, navigating conflicting interests, educate, foster engagement, drive decision-making Rachele Benjamin (DIGITAL INTEL...)	 Get answers: find the right resources, documentation, or people to get the answer efficiently. Rachele Benjamin (DIGITAL INTEL...)	 Interpret: summarize / synthesize data, trends, & documentation into actionable insights. Rachele Benjamin (DIGITAL INTEL...)	 Inform: document progress and alert stakeholders to communicate effectively. Rachele Benjamin (DIGITAL INTEL...)
 Research: exploring or researching a topic in-depth to gain new understanding Rachele Benjamin (DIGITAL INTEL...)	Create: produce valuable decks, memos, images, designs, graphs, charts, process maps, narratives, instructions, & translations Rachele Benjamin (DIGITAL INTEL...)	Collaborate: Edit, comment, share feedback & ideas to produce a better outcome Rachele Benjamin (DIGITAL INTEL...)	Learn: increase knowledge or develop a new skill Rachele Benjamin (DIGITAL INTEL...)	Stay up to date: access news / updates from inside and outside the organization to be in the know Rachele Benjamin (DIGITAL INTEL...)

User Motivations

Balance: work just hard enough to enjoy a life filled with friends, family, hobbies, and other projects.  Rachele Benjamin (DIGITAL INTEL...)	Stability: enjoy a safe & secure workplace. Rachele Benjamin (DIGITAL INTEL...)	Personal growth: be a life-long learner, face new challenges, develop as a human being.  Rachele Benjamin (DIGITAL INTEL...)
Get ahead: advance their career, achieve more. Rachele Benjamin (DIGITAL INTEL...)	Enjoyment: do what they love, love what they do. Rachele Benjamin (DIGITAL INTEL...)	Make a difference: Leave the world a better place than they found it.   Rachele Benjamin (DIGITAL INTEL...)

Recommendation

New Tab Page (NTP) that helps users stay motivated

Track their impact:

“When someone moves from a place of ignorance to understanding, that’s what I do it for.” –Elise, HR

Reveal puzzles & case studies:

“I like the challenge. I’m excited to problem-solve at work. It keeps me interested.” –Adnan, IT

Common JTBD across roles

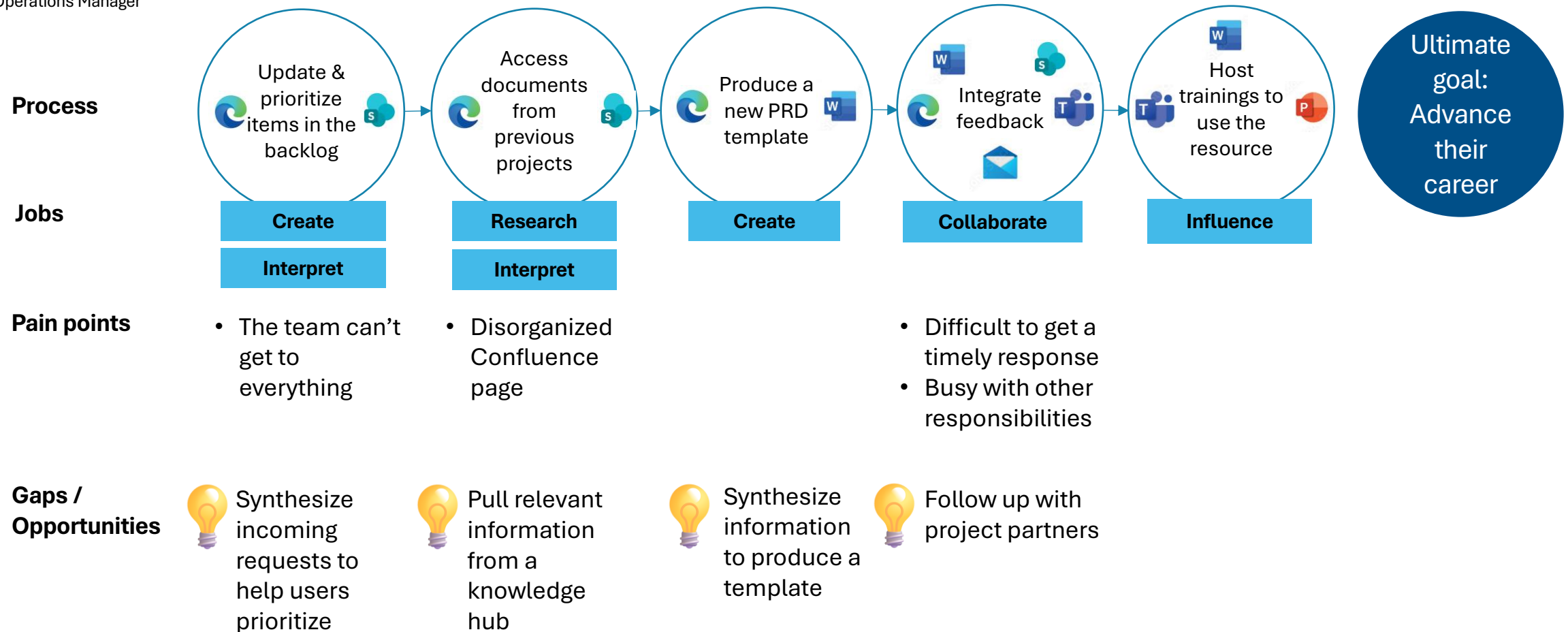
JTBD	Research / product	Customer-facing	IT roles	HR roles	Managing people
Inform					
Influence					
Interpret					
Get answers					
Plan / coordinate					
Research					
Create					
Collaborate					

More occasional JTBD: [Learn](#) [Stay up to date](#)



Julia, Tech, Product
Operations Manager

Research roles | Julia balances a lot, and Gen AI can streamline some tasks



Insight

Users may benefit from automation of social interactions, but their human intuition must steer the interaction

*“I worry that if an AI managed communication, **people would be less likely to respond...** or it would be considered rude.”*

-Julia, Product Operations

“They didn't call to talk to AI, they called to talk to a human. So, you know, just be more human.”

-Aurora, Social Services

Impact

Recommendation:

Give users full control over how they communicate and connect, while automation handles the work behind the scenes.

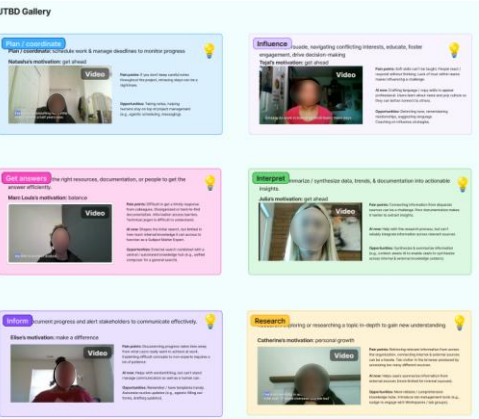
Outcomes:

Showcased scenarios at Ignite 2026

Laid the foundation for ideation & concept creation

Figma Make concept

Insight wall



New Tab Page concept

Good morning, Elise

Search positive feedback...

This Week

24

↑ 12% from last week



People Helped

156

This month



Avg. Sentiment

98%

Extremely positive



Impact Score

9.4

Out of 10



Recent Positive Feedback

Last 7 days



Sarah Chen

2 hours ago

Leave Management

"Thank you so much for walking me through the parental leave process. Your patience and thoroughness made what seemed overwhelming feel totally manageable!"



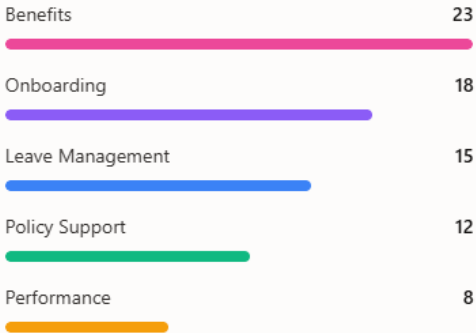
Marcus Johnson

Yesterday

Benefits

"I really appreciate how quickly you helped resolve my benefits question. You turned my stressful morning into a great day!"

Positive Impact by Category



Summary | Creating agentic AI experiences that support human decision-making

Study 1&2

 Agentic AI

Partner with users to streamline complex, multi-step tasks

Study 3 &4

 Shopping

User control matters because finances are sensitive, and because shopping is fun

Automation works when we understand intent—otherwise it solves the wrong problem.

Study 5

 Browser for Work

Automation handles what's behind the scenes & preserves how users connect with each other